



Cornell University

Master Beekeeper Program

Oral Exam

Student name

Student topic

Below is the rubric for the to the Cornell University Master Beekeeper Oral Exam. Students are required to give a 15-minute presentation on a research topic followed by a 5-minute question period.

Final Grade

/272

Criteria	Score
Content /107	
<i>Introduction (7 points)</i>	
The introduction is attention-getting, lays out the topic or question well, and establishes a framework for the rest of the presentation.	/3
The student describes the background of the chosen topic.	/2
The student defines the importance of the topic for beekeeping.	/2
<i>Body (83 points)</i>	
The content of the body was appropriate to the topic of the presentation.	/10
The presentation contains accurate information.	/10
The student demonstrated an advanced understanding of the topic, appropriate for a Master Beekeeper. The depth and breadth of information demonstrated mastery of the topic.	/20
Data or information from at least 5 outside sources are presented and cited on the visuals.	/15
The student did not stray from the topic with tangents.	/1
Information was presented in a logical order.	/5
The student demonstrated the correct use of terminology. Technical terms are well-defined in language appropriate for the target audience.	/5
<i>Conclusion (17 points)</i>	
There is an obvious conclusion or take-home-message summarizing the presentation.	/2
The student did a good job weaving the topic into a story or easy-to-follow summary.	/5
The student provided thoughtful and accurate answers to audience questions.	/10

Presentation skills /55	
Verbal delivery: The student spoke clearly and at a good volume. Delivery is poised, controlled, and smooth. The speaker spoke at a good pace (not too fast or slow).	/5
Physical presence: The student maintains good eye contact with the grader and is appropriately animated (e.g., gestures, moving around, etc.).	/5

Academic appropriateness: The student did not speak above (or beneath) the defined audience of experienced beekeepers (think a state or national beekeeping conference)	/5
The student's talk was between 12 and 15 minutes (excluding Q&A).	/5
The student used effective visuals.	/5
Visuals did not contain excessive information; they are simply organized and easy to glean information from.	/10
It is evident the student took time and care to craft their visuals.	/10
The student was well organized and prepared to give a presentation today. Overall, the presentation was refined and professional.	/10
Research skills: Experimental Design <i>Pertains only to students who conduct experiments</i> /55	
The student identified the outcome(s) being measured.	/1
The student identified treatment groups and control groups, if appropriate.	/2
The student controlled for all other factors that might influence the outcome(s).	/10
The student shared their methods (timeline, how they treated their colonies, how they measured outcomes, etc.)	/10
The student clearly identified his or her main findings.	/10
The student interpreted his or her findings appropriately.	/10
The student relates the findings to what other scientific articles have reported.	/10
The student identifies limitations to their project.	/1
The student identifies the next steps for future research.	/1
Research skills: Literature Review <i>Pertains only to students who conduct a literature review</i> /55	
The sources included are directly related to the presentation topic.	/10
The student summarized the information into a succinct, clear overview.	/15
The student demonstrated the ability to interpret and communicate the literature they reviewed.	/20
The sources the student used were reputable and included at least two articles from academic journals.	/10

Audience questions and/or additional comments: